

GitHub launches its mobile app

GitHub's mobile app for developers and other team members working on projects in GitHub repositories is now available for users of iOS and Android.

Ryan Nystrom, director of engineering, had announced the launch of the app in November last year. Since then, it has been in the beta version.

Coding on a handheld device is generally not a pleasant experience but this GitHub app has been aimed at all the other things that developers do, like raising or commenting on issues, approving pull requests, responding to notifications such as @ mentions, etc.

Developers can reach down to pull requests and observe the part of code that has been deleted or added. The application also incorporates syntax highlighting for prevalent programming languages.

GitHub created the app independently for Android and iOS, using Kotlin for Android and Swift for iOS. An intrinsic appearance and touch for both platforms has been favoured, instead of trying to develop a cross-platform UI or imitating the GitHub website. In an interview, Nystrom and GitHub designer Brian Lovin explained how they designed a mock-up for one platform and had the team on the other platform replicate it with appropriate adjustments. The downside of the approach is that the app works differently from visiting the GitHub website with a mobile browser, meaning there's more to learn.

A regular grievance is that the application only works with GitHub, and not with custom installations of GitHub Enterprise Server. As of this writing, ratings are better for Apple's platform (4.9 over 520 ratings) than for Android's (4.1 with 395 ratings).

compatible with Raspberry Pi 2, 3, 4, or even a Zero W. NymphCast has been developed in such a way that it can even support custom applications that can be deployed on the NymphCast server.

NymphCast applications are written using AngelScript, and use a library of methods and functions that work within the NymphCast runtime. Detailed information has been provided on the website for developers who wish to implement their own applications.

This project is still in its alpha phase.

Uber's Piranha automatically removes redundant application code

With Piranha, Uber Technologies Inc. has added another project to its open source repertoire. Piranha removes expired feature flags, which are software components essential to the continuous delivery methodology that supports modern enterprise software projects.

In effect, feature flags function as an *On-Off* switch for code. Uber uses them to help its developers test new features in its apps before releasing them to the public. Feature flags also offer a way to customise a facility for different users and double as a code kill switch, allowing developers to remotely incapacitate an out-of-order part of an application to stop it from hurting the entire program.



With benefits come certain drawbacks. Feature flags increase the complexity of an application's code base, and have to be manually removed once they outlive their purpose.

"These non-functional feature flags represent technical debt, making it difficult for developers to work on the code base, and can bloat our apps, requiring unnecessary operations that impact performance for the end user and potentially impact overall app reliability," the Uber engineers behind Piranha explained in a blog post.

Piranha tackles the challenge by mostly automating the removal of old feature flags. The tool finds all the feature flags in an application that have not been altered for a certain period of time, inspects whether they're in active use and, when it ascertains a component to be old, eliminates all the related code. Piranha